

Connect Your Email to LindaAI

So Sheriff can run your inbox for you

Gmail • Google Workspace • Outlook / Microsoft 365

Howdy, Boss. Hook up your email and **Sheriff (your Inbox Sentinel)** can read your inbox, search threads, draft replies for your approval, and run you a clean triage every morning. You stay the boss — Sheriff never sends a thing without your OK. This guide is built straight from Google's, Microsoft's, and Anthropic's official docs (sources at the bottom). Let's wire it up.

1. How email connects (the plain version)

LindaAI runs on Claude, and Claude reaches your email through a **connector** built on the **Model Context Protocol (MCP)** — an open standard for linking AI to your tools. You've got two paths:

- **One-click connector** — if a ready-made email connector shows in Claude's directory, turn it on and sign in. Easiest road; try this first.
- **Custom connector** — you create OAuth credentials with your provider (Google or Microsoft) and add them to Claude. Use this for additional accounts or providers without a one-click option.

Custom connectors are available on **Free, Pro, Max, Team, and Enterprise** plans.

2. What Sheriff can (and can't) do

Can: search your inbox, read full threads, create drafts (you review), label and organize messages. **Won't, without your explicit OK:** send mail, delete, or change settings. That's the approve-before-send rail LindaAI uses everywhere.

3. Connect a Gmail account (custom connector)

Step 1 — Create a Google Cloud project

Go to **console.cloud.google.com** project dropdown **New Project** name it

(e.g. "LindaAI Email") **Create**, and select it.

Step 2 — Enable the Gmail API

APIs & Services Library search **Gmail API Enable**.

Step 3 — Configure the OAuth consent screen

Open **Google Auth Platform** (or **APIs & Services OAuth consent screen**) and set:

- **App name** and your **support email**
- **User type: External** for a personal `@gmail.com` account *(Workspace admins can pick Internal — see §5)*
- Add the **scopes** Sheriff needs (from Google's Gmail API scopes):
- `https://www.googleapis.com/auth/gmail.readonly` — *view messages*
- `https://www.googleapis.com/auth/gmail.compose` — *manage drafts & send*
- Add your own Gmail address under **Test users**

Both scopes are **restricted**. For personal use, keep the app in **Testing** mode with yourself as a test user — that works with no verification. Public/production apps using restricted scopes must pass Google's OAuth verification + security assessment. You'll see an "unverified app" notice at sign-in for a testing app — expected, since you built it.

Step 4 — Create the OAuth client

Google Auth Platform Clients Create Client Application type: Web application

name it under **Authorized redirect URIs** add the callback URL shown in Claude's custom-connector dialog **Create**. Copy the **Client ID** and **Client Secret**.

Step 5 — Add the connector in Claude

Settings Customize Connectors "+" Add custom connector enter the Gmail **remote MCP server URL** (from Claude's connector directory or Google's current MCP docs) **Advanced settings** paste your **OAuth Client ID** and **Client Secret** **Add**.

Step 6 — Sign in & enable it

Authenticate with the Gmail account you added as a test user and grant the permissions. Turn the connector on for a chat via the **"+" Connectors** toggle. Done — Sheriff's got read + draft access.

Second Gmail? Reuse the same Cloud project + consent screen (§3 Steps 1-3), add the new address as a test user, make another OAuth client, and add a second custom connector.

4. Google Workspace (business email)

Same flow as Gmail, with one perk: if you're the **Workspace admin**, choose **Internal** on the consent screen — everyone in your domain can authenticate, with no test-user list and no "unverified app" notice. Not the admin? Use **External** and add your address as a test user, exactly like personal Gmail.

5. Outlook / Microsoft 365

Microsoft uses **Azure** credentials and **Microsoft Graph** instead of Google Cloud.

1. portal.azure.com Microsoft Entra ID App registrations New registration

- Name it; for **Redirect URI**, choose **Web** and use the callback URL from Claude's custom-connector dialog.

2. **API permissions Add a permission Microsoft Graph Delegated permissions**, then add (official Graph permission names):

- **Mail.Read** — read mail
- **Mail.ReadWrite** — organize / label mail
- **Mail.Send** — send mail
- **User.Read** — basic profile

3. **Certificates & secrets New client secret** copy the **value** right away.

4. Add it in Claude as a custom connector (same as §3 Step 5), using the current Outlook MCP server URL from Claude's directory or Microsoft's official MCP docs.

6. Permissions cheat-sheet

Provider	Read	Organize	Send
Google (Gmail)	gmail.readonly	<i>(compose)</i>	gmail.compose
Microsoft (Graph)	Mail.Read	Mail.ReadWrite	Mail.Send

Least-privilege tip (Microsoft's own advice): only grant what you actually need.

7. Turn on daily triage

Once connected, tell LindaAI:

```
"Every morning, scan my inbox for unread from the last 24 hours. Sort into Urgent / Action  
/ FYI / Ignore, urgent first."
```

LindaAI ships `/inbox-triage`, `/mail-sweep`, and Sheriff for exactly this — and you can schedule it to land in your Telegram each morning.

8. Troubleshooting

- **"Access blocked: request is invalid"** your redirect URI must match the one Claude shows, exactly.
- **"Unverified app"** normal for a personal app in Testing mode; choose Advanced proceed.
- **Workspace "app blocked"** an admin must allow third-party API access (admin.google.com Security API controls).
- **No "Connectors" option** confirm you're signed in to a supported plan.

9. Sources (official docs)

- Google — Create access credentials: developers.google.com/workspace/guides/create-credentials
- Google — Gmail API OAuth scopes: developers.google.com/workspace/gmail/api/auth/scopes
- Microsoft — Graph permissions reference: learn.microsoft.com/graph/permissions-reference
- Anthropic — Get started with custom connectors (remote MCP): [support.claude.com](https://support.claude.com/custom-connectors) (custom connectors)

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